Waziristan. It was also written in the letter that the TTP had procured 200 litres of poisonous material that would be used to contaminate water sources and reservoirs in the wards falling under the RCB and CCB limits. It alarmed the authorities. The tube-well operators and valve men were issued special instructions to keep the doors of their offices closed where tube well was installed and other water equipment was placed (*The News International*, 2009).

They also started attacking NATO supply trucks, terminals and police check posts in Chaman (*The Nation*, 2009). The security was beefed up at bordering areas with Afghanistan, particularly at Chaman, Nushki and Chagai districts to stop Afghan Taliban entering Pakistan territory (*The Nation*, 2009).

There was a new fear when the interior minister of Pakistan declared that South Punjab could be the next Swat (*The Daily Times*, 2009). He gave two reasons for it: first, jihadi militias like LeJ and JeM hailed from South Punjab; secondly, perhaps all those terrorists who fled from Waziristan or Swat might have taken refuge in South Punjab.

Three aspects were often ignored when predicting the emergence of Swat like the situation in South Punjab: (1) The presence of Punjabis in the ranks of TTP should not come as a surprise because Punjabis had always been a major part of Mujahideen from the Afghan jihad period, Sufi Muhammad's lashkar to fight on Taliban side in Afghanistan in 2001 and later the TTP in FATA. (2) Proscribed organisations like SSP, LeJ and JeM lost their militant command and structure. Therefore, they were not part of TTP as organisations. However, some of its extremist members joined with the TTP. (3) Unlike FATA and Swat, Punjab's terrain was not suitable for guerrilla warfare (*The Daily Times*, 2009).

These mitigating aspects, however, did not diminish the danger. The scattered members of proscribed organisations have become the 'sleeper agents', facilitators and also active members who provided shelters to TTP fighters, offered hideouts for training and planning and joined the active cadres of fighters and suicide bombers. The blast carried out using stored suicide jackets and rocket launchers, in the house of a militant in Mian Channu, which killed 22 persons, including seven children in the adjacent madrasah, confirmed this fear (*The Nation*, 2009).

Some other factors (*The Daily Times*, 2009) that added to the apprehension that South Punjab, comprising 13 districts, having a